

COURSE TITLE: BUSINESS ENGLISH FOR ICT	
LEVEL: BACHELOR DURATION: 12HR CREDITS:	

COURSE OBJECTIVES:

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

Communicate effectively in business and ICT-related situations.

Write professional emails, reports, and technical documents.

Participate confidently in meetings, presentations, and negotiations.

Develop business vocabulary related to ICT.

Understand and apply key grammatical structures for business communication.

Course Outline:

Module 1: Introduction to Business English in ICT

Understanding Business English and its importance in ICT.

Key differences between general and business communication.

Common business communication challenges for ICT professionals.

Module 2: Business Vocabulary for ICT

Essential business and ICT terms.

Formal vs. informal language in business communication.

Using precise and concise language in business writing.

Module 3: Email Writing and Professional Correspondence

Structure of a professional email.

Writing clear and effective subject lines.

Formal vs. informal emails.

Email etiquette and common mistakes.

Writing inquiry, complaint, and request emails.

Module 4: Report and Proposal Writing in ICT

Structure of ICT business reports.

Writing executive summaries.

Formatting and presenting data effectively.

Writing ICT project proposals and business plans.

Module 5: Business Meetings and Communication

Planning and organizing business meetings.

Writing meeting agendas and minutes.

Effective communication in virtual meetings.

Role-playing ICT business meetings.

Module 6: Business Presentations and Public Speaking

Preparing a professional business presentation.

Structuring presentations for technical and non-technical audiences.

Using PowerPoint and visual aids effectively.

Public speaking skills for ICT professionals.

Module 7: Negotiation and Persuasion in Business

Persuasive communication in business.

Negotiation strategies in ICT business settings.

Handling objections and conflict resolution.

LEARNING RESOURCES:

Books:

Business Communication Today by Bovee & Thill

Technical Writing for Engineers & IT Professionals by Styler

Online Resources:

Coursera & Udemy Business English courses

Grammarly & Hemingway for writing assistance

TED Talks on business communication

MODULE 1: INTRODUCTION TO BUSINESS ENGLISH

LESSON OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

Define Business English and its key components.

Explain the importance of Business English in ICT.

Identify common Business English communication challenges in ICT.

Recognize real-world applications of Business English in ICT workplaces.

Lesson Outline

1. Introduction to Business English

What is Business English?

Business English refers to the specific language and communication skills used in professional and corporate settings. It includes:

Formal communication (emails, reports, and presentations).

Industry-specific vocabulary.

Professional etiquette and tone.

Clear and concise writing and speaking skills.

How Business English Differs from General English

2. Importance of Business English in ICT

Why is Business English Important for ICT Professionals?

Effective Workplace Communication – ICT professionals need to communicate with clients, managers, and colleagues. Miscommunication can lead to project failures.

Professional Email Writing – Emails are the primary mode of communication in ICT companies.

Poorly written emails can create misunderstandings.

Technical Report Writing – ICT professionals write reports, proposals, and user manuals. Clear and structured writing ensures proper documentation.

Presentations & Meetings – Business English helps in delivering impactful presentations and participating in discussions.

Job Applications & Career Growth – Writing a strong CV, cover letter, and LinkedIn profile is essential for career advancement.

Global Collaboration – ICT is a global industry where professionals work with international teams.
English is the dominant language in global ICT businesses.

3. Common Business English Challenges for ICT Professionals

Using overly technical language – Some ICT professionals struggle to explain technical terms to non-technical audiences.

Lack of formal writing skills – Writing business emails and reports requires specific structures and tones.

Speaking in professional settings – Many ICT professionals find it difficult to speak.

PARTS OF SPEECH

One of the groups that words are divide into, for example noun, verb, adjective, etc...

NOUN Ashoka King, Delhi, City, Rose, Sun, Gold, Class, Honesty, Policy...	PRONOUN He, She, It, They, This, That, Theses, Those
ADJECTIVE Beautiful, Tall, Happy, Intelligent, Brave, Kind, Generous, Funny....	VERB Run,, Eat, Write, Kill, Go, Is, Are Has, Had
ADVERB Quickly, Slowly, Carefully, Happily, Loudly, Quietly, Well, Badly, Easily...	PREPOSITION In, On, At, With, Of, To, Upon, Over, Under, By....
CONJUNCTION And, But, Nor, So, Yet, For, Because, Although, Though....	INTERJECTION Wow, Oh, Ouch, Ah, Oops, Yay, Hurray, Alas, Bravo, Phew, Hey...

SOME EXERCISES

EXERCISE 1: IDENTIFY THE PART OF SPEECH

Identify the part of speech (noun, verb, adjective, adverb, pronoun, conjunction, preposition, or interjection) for each ICT-related word in the sentence.

1. The software installed on my computer is very efficient.
2. She downloads the latest updates every week.
3. This wireless router provides a fast connection.
4. The technician solved the issue quickly.
5. Wow! This new AI assistant is amazing!
6. The database contains thousands of records.
7. The hacker bypassed the firewall and accessed the server.
8. My files are stored in the cloud.
9. They develop applications for mobile users.
10. The encrypted data cannot be accessed without a key.

EXERCISE 2: FILL IN THE BLANKS

Complete the sentences with the correct ICT-related word in the appropriate form.

1. A _____ (noun) is used to store digital files and folders.
2. We need to _____ (verb) this antivirus software to protect our system.
3. The programmer wrote a very _____ (adjective) code that runs efficiently.
4. He browsed the internet _____ (adverb) to find a solution to his problem.
5. The technician explained that the device would not work _____ (conjunction) we update the firmware.
6. Cybersecurity experts always advise users to use strong _____ (noun) for their accounts.
7. The system administrator must _____ (verb) the network settings before deployment.
8. Our website loads _____ (adverb) because of the new server.
9. I prefer using a wireless mouse _____ (preposition) a wired one.
10. _____! (Interjection) I forgot to back up my data before formatting my laptop.

EXERCISE 3: IDENTIFY THE VERB AND ITS TENSE

Identify the verb in each sentence and state its tense (Present, Past, Future, Present Perfect, etc.).

1. The developer writes code for a new mobile app.
2. The system crashed due to a power failure.
3. By next year, the company will launch an AI assistant.
4. The technician has fixed the network issue.
5. The students are learning about cybersecurity in class.
6. The programmer had completed the software before the deadline.
7. The IT team was troubleshooting the error when the manager arrived.
8. The engineer will be designing a new security system next month.
9. He has been working on this project for three months.
10. The company develops cloud storage solutions.

EXERCISE 4: FILL IN THE BLANKS WITH THE CORRECT VERB TENSE

Use the correct verb tense of the verb in parentheses.

1. Every day, the IT department _____ (update) the system. (Present Simple)
2. Yesterday, the hacker _____ (bypass) the firewall. (Past Simple)
3. The programmer _____ (test) the software right now. (Present Continuous)
4. By next week, we _____ (complete) the website. (Future Perfect)
5. The server _____ (run) slowly before we upgraded it. (Past Continuous)
6. Since morning, the developer _____ (debug) the application. (Present Perfect Continuous)
7. They _____ (install) the software when the system crashed. (Past Continuous)
8. Next month, the team _____ (launch) a new app. (Future Simple)
9. She _____ (not/finish) the project yet. (Present Perfect)
10. I _____ (download) the antivirus before the virus attack. (Past Perfect)

EXERCISE 5: REWRITE THE SENTENCES IN THE GIVEN TENSE

Change the verb in each sentence to match the requested tense.

1. (Past Simple) The developer is fixing the bug. → _____
2. (Future Continuous) The IT team updates the security patches. → _____
3. (Present Perfect) The company launched a new website last month. → _____
4. (Past Perfect) The students learn how to code. → _____
5. (Future Perfect Continuous) She is designing a new software feature. → _____

MODULE 4

LESSON: REPORTED SPEECH WITH AI-RELATED VOCABULARY

Lesson Objectives:

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

Understand the rules of reported speech.

Apply these rules to AI-related vocabulary.

Convert direct speech to reported speech accurately.

Practice with AI-related exercises.

1. Introduction to Reported Speech

What is Reported Speech?

Reported speech (or indirect speech) is used when we report what someone else has said without quoting their exact words.

Example:

Direct Speech: The researcher said, "AI is transforming industries."

Reported Speech: The researcher said that AI was transforming industries.

2. Rules of Reported Speech

A. Changes in Tenses

Exception:

If the statement is a general truth, we do not change the tense.

Direct: "AI depends on data."

Reported: He said AI depends on data. (General truth, no change)

B. Changes in Pronouns

Pronouns often change depending on the speaker.

C. Changes in Time Expressions

3. Reporting Different Sentence Types

A. Reporting Statements

Use "said", "stated", or "mentioned" and change the tense accordingly.

Example:

Direct: "AI will replace repetitive tasks."

Reported: The expert said that AI would replace repetitive tasks.

B. Reporting Questions

Yes/No Questions → Use "asked if" or "wanted to know if".

Direct: "Is AI safe to use?"

Reported: He asked if AI was safe to use.

Wh- Questions → Use "asked" or "wanted to know" + question word.

Direct: "How does machine learning work?"

Reported: She asked how machine learning worked.

C. Reporting Commands & Requests

Use "told" or "asked" + to + verb for commands.

Direct: "Train the AI model carefully."

Reported: The professor told them to train the AI model carefully.

Use "asked" + to + verb for polite requests.

Direct: "Can you explain neural networks?"

Reported: He asked me to explain neural networks.

4. Exercises on Reported Speech with AI Vocabulary

Exercise 1: Convert to Reported Speech

Rewrite the following sentences in reported speech.

The engineer said, "AI is improving every year."

The researcher stated, "Deep learning models have revolutionized healthcare."

The scientist said, "We will release a new AI-powered assistant tomorrow."

The developer asked, "How does the AI chatbot handle customer queries?"

The professor told us, "Read more about natural language processing."

Exercise 2: Correct the Mistakes

Identify and correct the errors in the following reported speech sentences.

The expert said that AI can solve complex problems. (Check the tense!)

He asked if machine learning works like the human brain.

She told that AI will replace many tasks. (Check the reporting verb!)

They said they are working on a new AI tool last week. (Check the tense sequence!)

Exercise 3: Write Your Own Sentences

Write a sentence in direct speech about AI ethics.

Convert your sentence into reported speech.

5. Summary

Reported speech is used to retell someone's words.

Tenses change when shifting from direct to reported speech.

Pronouns, time expressions, and question structures also change.

Statements, questions, and commands have different reporting structures.

MODULE 5

LESSON: EMAIL WRITING & PROFESSIONAL CORRESPONDENCE

Lesson Objectives:

By the end of this lesson, learners will be able to:

Understand the structure of a professional email.

Write clear, concise, and polite emails for ICT and business contexts.

Use appropriate tone, formatting, and etiquette in emails.

Avoid common email writing mistakes.

1. Introduction to Email Writing

Email is a crucial tool for professional communication in ICT and business. Well-written emails ensure clarity, efficiency, and professionalism in workplace communication.

Types of Professional Emails:

Inquiry Emails (Request for information)

Response Emails (Replying to inquiries)

Complaint Emails (Reporting issues)

Job Application Emails (Cover letters)

Meeting or Invitation Emails

Apology Emails

Follow-up Emails

2. Structure of a Professional Email

A professional email typically follows this structure:

1. Subject Line

Keep it clear and concise.

Example: "Request for Software Update Assistance"

2. Salutation (Greeting)

If you know the recipient's name: "Dear Mr. Smith," or "Dear Dr. Johnson,"

If you don't know the recipient's name: "Dear Sir/Madam," or "To Whom It May Concern,"

3. Opening Sentence (Introduction)

State the purpose of your email clearly.

Example: "I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to request assistance with..."

4. Main Body (Details)

Provide necessary details without being too long.

Use short paragraphs for clarity.

Example:

"Our team has been experiencing issues with the recent software update. The system crashes frequently, and we would appreciate your guidance on resolving this issue."

5. Closing Sentence (Call to Action)

Politely state what action you expect.

Example: "Please let me know if you require any further details. I look forward to your response."

6. Closing & Signature

Common closings:

"Best regards,"

"Sincerely,"

"Kind regards,"

Include your name, job title, and contact information.

Example:

John Doe

Software Engineer

ABC Tech Solutions

john.doe@example.com

3. Example of a Professional Email

Scenario: Requesting IT Support

SUBJECT: URGENT: ASSISTANCE NEEDED FOR NETWORK ISSUE

Dear IT Support Team,

I hope this email finds you well. I am reaching out regarding an urgent issue with our office network. Since this morning, our team has been unable to access the shared server, affecting our workflow.

Could you please investigate this issue and provide a possible solution at your earliest convenience?

If you require any further details, please let me know.

Looking forward to your prompt response.

Best regards,

Jane Smith
Operations Manager
XYZ Corporation
jane.smith@xyzcorp.com

4. Professional Email Etiquette

Be concise: Avoid long paragraphs. Keep emails brief and to the point.

Use professional language: Avoid slang, abbreviations, or informal phrases.

Proofread before sending: Check for grammar, spelling, and formatting errors.

Be polite: Use respectful language and proper greetings.

Use a professional email address: Avoid personal or informal email addresses.

5. Common Mistakes in Professional Emails

6. Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Identify Mistakes

Read the email below and identify the mistakes:

Subject: Help Needed

Hey IT Team,

Hope ur doing good. We are having problem with the software update. Can u check?

Thanks,

Tom

→ Task: Rewrite this email in a professional format.

Exercise 2: Write a Professional Email

Write an email for one of the following situations:

Requesting remote access to a company database.

Following up on a job application.

Reporting a security breach.

MODULE 6

1. Preparing a Professional Business Presentation

Step 1: Understanding Your Audience

Identify your audience: Are they experts in the field, beginners, or a mix? For ICT professionals, understanding their level of knowledge is key.

Tailor the message: Adjust the depth of the information based on whether your audience is technical or non-technical.

Step 2: Define Clear Objectives

Purpose of the presentation: Are you informing, persuading, or solving a problem? Clarify this before you begin.

Key takeaway: What should your audience remember after your presentation?

Step 3: Organize the Content

Introduction:

Greet the audience.

Briefly introduce yourself and the topic.

State the agenda and objectives.

Body:

Break it down into 3–5 key points.

Ensure a logical flow—don't jump between topics abruptly.

Use visuals (charts, graphs, diagrams) to explain complex ICT concepts clearly.

Conclusion:

Summarize the key takeaways.

Call to action (if applicable)—What should your audience do with the information?

Step 4: Visual Design

Consistency: Use professional templates, simple fonts, and clear text. Avoid cluttering slides.

High-quality visuals: Use relevant images, icons, or diagrams to reinforce your points.

Limit text: Focus on keywords or bullet points. Avoid reading directly from slides.

Step 5: Rehearse and Fine-tune

Practice timing: Aim to stay within the allocated time.

Refine transitions: Ensure smooth transitions between slides or topics.

Use notes: Have speaker notes to guide you but don't rely on them too heavily.

2. Public Speaking Skills for ICT Professionals

Step 1: Confidence

Prepare thoroughly: The more you know your material, the more confident you'll be.

Positive body language: Stand tall, make eye contact, and use hand gestures to emphasize points.

Practice: Rehearse in front of a mirror or with a friend to gain confidence.

Step 2: Clear Communication

Speak clearly: Use a pace that's easy to follow. Don't rush through complex topics.

Simplify jargon: ICT terminology can be overwhelming. Explain terms or concepts in layman's terms if necessary.

Engage your audience: Ask questions or encourage participation to keep the audience engaged.

Step 3: Body Language

Gestures: Use natural hand movements to complement your speech.

Posture: Stand confidently, avoid slouching, and use the space around you (if appropriate).

Facial expressions: Express enthusiasm or seriousness, depending on the tone of the presentation.

Step 4: Handling Nerves

Breathing: Deep, slow breaths can help calm nerves.

Preparation: The more you prepare, the less nervous you will feel.

Visualization: Visualize a successful presentation to build your confidence.

Step 5: Responding to Questions

Stay calm: If you don't know the answer to a question, it's okay to admit it. Offer to follow up after the presentation.

Clarify: If a question is unclear, ask for clarification before answering.

Interactive discussion: Encourage questions as a way of keeping your audience engaged.

Practical Exercise:

To put this into action, you could:

Create a 5-minute ICT-related presentation on a topic of your choice (e.g., cloud computing, cybersecurity, AI in business).

Prepare slides using the structure outlined above.

Practice delivering the presentation, paying attention to your tone, pace, and body language.

Afterward, you could either ask a friend for feedback or reflect on areas for improvement.

By practicing these steps and focusing on communication, you can improve your public speaking and presentation skills for ICT professionals.

LESSON: PASSIVE VOICE

1. What is Passive Voice?

In passive voice, the object of the sentence becomes the focus, and the subject (the doer of the action) may not always be mentioned. The focus is on the action itself or the receiver of the action.

Structure of Passive Voice:

Object + to be (in the correct tense) + Past Participle (Verb 3) + (by + Subject)

For example:

Active voice: "The developer created the software."

Passive voice: "The software was created by the developer."

Notice that in passive voice, the object (the software) becomes the subject of the sentence, and the doer (the developer) is often introduced with "by" (but sometimes omitted if it's unknown or irrelevant).

2. When to Use Passive Voice:

When the doer of the action is unknown or irrelevant: "The system was updated."

When you want to emphasize the action or the object rather than the doer: "The report was submitted on time."

In formal or scientific writing: Passive voice is often used in research papers, reports, and technical writing.

3. Passive Voice vs. Active Voice:

Let's create a comparative chart between active voice and passive voice:

4. Exercises on Passive Voice

Exercise 1: Identifying Active and Passive Voice

Read the following sentences and identify whether they are in active voice or passive voice.

The manager approved the proposal.

The document was reviewed by the legal team.

The engineer designed the new software feature.

The error was fixed by the IT department.

The company launched the new product.

Exercise 2: Converting Active to Passive Voice

Rewrite the following active voice sentences into passive voice.

The team developed a new application.

The marketing department will launch the campaign next week.

The technician repaired the equipment.

The researcher completed the study on time.

The company announced the new policy.

Exercise 3: Completing Sentences in Passive Voice

Complete the following sentences in passive voice:

The report _____ (submit) by the team yesterday.

The software _____ (update) regularly by the IT department.

The decision _____ (make) by the board members next week.

The meeting _____ (hold) every Friday.

The issue _____ (resolve) by the support team.

Exercise 4: Rewriting Sentences for Emphasis

For each of the following active voice sentences, rewrite the sentence in passive voice to emphasize the object or action.

The IT team will fix the server.

The customer service team handles the complaints.

The manager approved the project.

The team developed a new product.

The team delivered the presentation.

MODULE 7

LESSON: PERSUASIVE COMMUNICATION IN BUSINESS WITH A CASE STUDY ON CONFLICT RESOLUTION

1. Introduction to Persuasive Communication

Persuasive communication is the art of influencing others' attitudes, behaviors, or opinions through strategic and effective communication techniques. It's essential in business for motivating teams, convincing stakeholders, negotiating deals, and resolving conflicts.

Key Principles of Persuasive Communication:

Clarity: Be clear about what you're asking for or proposing.

Empathy: Understand the other person's point of view and address their needs.

Credibility: Build trust by demonstrating knowledge and reliability.

Logical Reasoning: Provide sound reasoning and evidence to back up your arguments.

Emotional Appeal: Tap into the emotions of your audience to make your message resonate.

2. The Role of Persuasive Communication in Conflict Resolution

In business, conflicts can arise from misunderstandings, differing values, or competing interests.

Persuasive communication helps resolve these conflicts by:

Defusing tension: Addressing emotional undercurrents in conflicts.

Negotiation: Finding mutually beneficial solutions.

Encouraging collaboration: Moving from a competitive to a cooperative mindset.

3. Steps for Persuasive Communication in Conflict Resolution

Step 1: Understanding the Conflict

Active listening: Listen to both sides without judgment. Reflect back what you've heard to ensure understanding.

Identify needs: Uncover the root cause of the conflict. What does each party need to feel satisfied?

Step 2: Framing the Issue Constructively

Use “I” statements: This reduces defensiveness (e.g., “I feel concerned when deadlines are missed” rather than “You never meet deadlines”).

Reframe the problem: Shift the perspective from a win-lose scenario to a win-win. Focus on collaboration and shared goals.

Step 3: Propose Solutions with Benefits

Offer compromises: Find middle ground that addresses the interests of both parties.

Use logical reasoning: Present how the solution benefits both parties (e.g., how timely collaboration can improve team efficiency).

Appeal to emotions: Show empathy, acknowledging the emotional concerns of the parties involved.

Step 4: Negotiate and Reach Consensus

Provide alternatives: Give both parties options for resolution, which creates a sense of choice and control.

Clarify next steps: Ensure both sides agree on a clear path forward and responsibilities.

4. Case Study: Conflict Resolution in an ICT Business Setting

Context:

Two teams in an IT company are in conflict over resource allocation for an important software project. Team A believes they should get more resources because their part of the project is crucial for the final delivery. Team B argues that their work is just as critical, and any delay will lead to a negative impact on the product.

Step 1: Understanding the Conflict

The first step is for both teams' leaders to meet and actively listen to their concerns. Each leader explains their team's perspective, and the importance of the project milestones is discussed. Both sides feel their team's work is critical.

Step 2: Framing the Issue Constructively

The leaders use "I" statements to express their frustrations without placing blame. For example:

Team A's leader: "I'm concerned that if we don't have the necessary resources now, we may not meet our deadline."

Team B's leader: "I feel frustrated because we also need more resources to ensure our component is ready on time."

Both leaders reframe the issue: "How can we distribute resources to ensure both teams can meet their objectives and contribute equally to the project?"

Step 3: Propose Solutions with Benefits

Negotiating a Solution: The leaders brainstorm solutions, offering alternatives that benefit both teams. They decide to:

Agree that once Team A completes the initial tasks, resources will shift to Team B to ensure their phase moves forward smoothly.

Appealing to Emotional Needs: Both leaders express understanding and empathy for the pressure their teams are under, and they highlight the importance of collaboration in achieving project success.

Step 4: Negotiate and Reach Consensus

Both teams agree to a resource-sharing plan and agree on the specific milestones to ensure timely delivery.

Clear next steps are outlined: Regular meetings are scheduled for progress updates and adjustments if necessary.

5. Lessons Learned from the Case Study

Effective communication: Both leaders used persuasive communication techniques to resolve the conflict constructively.

Empathy and collaboration: Recognizing the emotional needs of each team helped them come to a resolution that acknowledged both sides' concerns.

Logical reasoning and clear solutions: Proposing a practical solution that was based on logical reasoning (resource allocation to meet deadlines) led to a positive outcome.

6. Practical Exercise:

Scenario Practice: In pairs, take turns acting as team leaders dealing with a conflict. One person plays the role of the leader of Team A, and the other plays the leader of Team B. Use persuasive communication techniques to negotiate a resolution based on a similar conflict scenario.

Feedback: After each role play, give feedback on the clarity of communication, empathy, and ability to propose practical solutions.

Conclusion:

Persuasive communication is a powerful tool in resolving conflicts in the business world. By understanding the conflict, framing issues constructively, and proposing solutions that benefit all parties, professionals can navigate and resolve even the most difficult conflicts in a way that leads to collaboration and business success.

Thank you